

Programming skills are also coveted

Developers who wish to secure their foothold in the shrinking job market need to possess razor-sharp open source programming skills. Many studies indicate that there will be a surge in the demand for tech professionals armed with programming skills this year too. "There is a lack of true developers in the country and so programming skills will always be in huge demand. It's not easy to master all the programming languages, thus there is a widening skills gap in this terrain. Job prospects are upbeat for prospective programmers who have knowhow on programming languages like PHP, Perl, Python, Ajax, C, C++, Ruby and more," quips Manish Bhojasia, founder and director at Sanfoundry, a high-end technology training company.

Market your storage skills

Industry stalwarts also predict that getting equipped with the right set of storage skills can get you hired this year. Dr Rajeev Papneja, COO, ESDS Software Solutions Pvt Ltd, feels that the demand for storage skills will increase in the coming years—one of the major reasons being the exponential growth in data. "The SAN and NAS storage systems used by enterprises are very costly and SMEs are looking for a mid-level storage option, which would only be possible by going the open source route. SMBs constitute the major chunk of users and they are trying various ways and means to cut their IT costs. Besides, different kinds of companies require different skill sets. In general, you need to be well versed with as many open source technologies as possible with a very good understanding of all technologies. The more active you are in the open source community, the quicker your journey up the ladder to success," says Dr Papneja.

Security skills are in demand too

Open source professionals with the right mix of proven security skills, professional certifications and government security clearances will have a competitive edge in the recruitment landscape this year. With the rise in sophisticated cyber crimes, cyber sleuths are now much in demand to secure valuable information systems. The advent of mobile technology has given rise to a new breed of professionals who work as Android penetration testing experts, iOS intrusion

testing experts and more, says Tamaghna Basu, who works as a cyber security expert at an online shopping portal.

Bring the FOSS curriculum up to industry standards

At a time when these FOSS skills hold the promise of better jobs, the curriculums of most schools and colleges in India do not provide students the ideal exposure to open source software. So what do the experts have to say about this? "In the coming years, open source software will be an integral part of the curriculum. In fact, some schools have already introduced it in their prospectus. My child is in the 5th standard and is already programming in Java, and it is a part of the computer course in the school. It is really the popularity and the demand for certain software that drives curriculum in schools and colleges. As open source becomes more and more popular and the demand for open source professionals rises, schools and colleges will have no choice but to go with the flow. So, it is not a question of a choice between whether to teach OSS or not now, it is really a question of *when*—which I personally see happening currently," says Dr Papneja.

Echoing similar views, Kavir Munshi says, "Colleges and schools in India need to radically update their curriculum as far as open source is concerned. We can see the emerging technologies and trends, and simultaneously find that the students at colleges in India are lacking in those technologies. We have been working with a lot of colleges around India to conduct OpenStack-based workshops. This helps students to hit the ground running when they are looking to get employed. We have also started a curriculum development programme to work with universities and colleges to introduce OpenStack and a cloud-based curriculum into their classrooms. This will give an edge to the students who enter the workforce in the near future."

The verdict? This year is definitely a bullish market for all those who are armed with a bagful of FOSS skills. So, gear up and update your FOSS toolbox to make your presence felt in the job landscape! 

By Priyanka Sarkar

The author is a member of the editorial team. She loves to weave in and out the little nuances of life and scribble her thoughts and experiences in her personal blog.

**Read more stories on
security and surveillance in
www.electronicb2b.com**

TOP SECURITY STORIES

- CCTV camera market is expected to double by 2015
- The latest in biometric devices
- CCTV camera manufacturers can look forward to a bright future
- Video Analytics Systems Turning a CCTV into a proactive tool
- Security cameras evolving with new technologies
- The latest in dome cameras
- The latest in weather-proof and vandal-resistant security cameras

**ELECTRONICS
B2B**
INDUSTRY IS AT A

CLICK OF A BUTTON

Log on to www.electronicb2b.com and be in touch with the Electronics B2B Fraternity 24x7